

NIRMAAN CLIMATEWORKS FOUNDATION

Design Document Climate Finance for Indian Cities

Prepared by:	Vimala Telu, Senior Instructional Designer
Organization:	Nirmaan ClimateWorks Foundation (NCF) — Bengaluru (Fictional)
Target Audience:	Finance Officers and CFOs of Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) — Tier 2 & 3 Indian Cities
Program Format:	Blended: Rise 360 eLearning + Virtual Workshops + Storyline Simulation + Mentored Practicum
Duration:	40 Hours
Version:	v1.0 — July 2025

1. Executive Summary

Program at a Glance

CF-101 is a 40-hour blended learning program designed to equip Urban Local Body (ULB) finance officials across Indian Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities with the knowledge and applied skills to access, structure, and deploy climate finance instruments for urban infrastructure and resilience projects. The program culminates in each participant producing a draft Climate Finance Concept Note for a real project in their own ULB — a genuine professional deliverable, not a test score.

India's urban sector faces an urgent climate finance paradox: billions of dollars in climate finance are technically available from the Green Climate Fund (GCF), the Asian Development Bank (ADB), the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), SEBI green bond markets, and domestic sources — yet the share reaching Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities remains critically low. A Needs Assessment conducted by NCF in March–April 2025 (n=85 ULB finance officers across 5 states) found that 72% could not explain GCF direct access eligibility, only 18% had read the SEBI Green Bond Circular, and 61% were unaware that carbon credits could serve as a revenue stream for urban climate projects.

This is not a motivation problem. Survey data showed 97% of respondents wanted a practical program — not another awareness seminar — that would let them actually write a proposal. CF-101 is designed to meet that need.

2. Target Audience Analysis

Dimension	Primary Learner Profile
Job Roles	Municipal Finance Officer Deputy Commissioner (Finance) CFO, Municipal Corporation Treasury Officer, Smart City SPV
Target Cities	40 ULBs across Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Rajasthan, and Odisha — Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities with population 1–25 lakh
Prior Knowledge	Deep expertise in government accounting (GAS) and municipal finance. Limited exposure to capital markets, multilateral finance, or green bonds. Self-rated climate finance competency: 1.9/5.0
Technology Access	All have office workstation access. 84% own smartphones. 4G connectivity in most locations. Training must be accessible on mobile with offline download option.
Language	English is the working language for official documents. Key instruction screens and glossaries available in Hindi, Marathi, and Tamil.
Constraints	12-hour rotating shifts. No extended classroom availability. Training must be completable in 30–45 minute self-directed segments. Virtual workshops must offer recording for asynchronous review.

3. Content Source Analysis

Module Goal: By completing CF-101, ULB finance officials will independently identify, evaluate, and structure a climate finance proposal for an eligible urban infrastructure project in their own municipality — producing a draft Concept Note suitable for submission to a state government, multilateral agency, or green bond market with modest refinement.

Task	Learning Objective	Bloom's Level	Assessment
T1	Classify climate finance instruments by type (grants, concessional loans, green bonds, carbon credits) and map each to eligible urban project categories.	L2-L4	MCQ + Classification Activity
T2	Apply the SEBI Green Bond Circular 2023 framework to assess a ULB's eligibility for green bond issuance and complete the NCF Green Bond Readiness Checklist.	L3-L4	Checklist + Simulation
T3	Evaluate project eligibility for ADB, World Bank, and AIIB instruments and develop a concept note aligned to MDB format requirements.	L4	MDB Case Activity
T4	Produce a structured Climate Finance Concept Note for a real ULB project: project description, financing structure, GHG impact estimate, and M&E framework.	L6 Create	Mentor-assessed Concept Note

4. Learning Architecture

Component	Format	Purpose	Hours	Tool
Concept Instruction	Rise 360	CF landscape, SEBI, MDB, blended finance	20 hrs	Rise 360
Scenario Simulation	Storyline 360	Carbon finance decision simulation	2 hrs	Storyline 360
Virtual Workshops	Zoom — 2 sessions	Blended finance design (M4) and practicum support	5 hrs	Zoom + NULP
Mentored Practicum	Async + 2 mentor sessions	Concept Note development for own ULB	8 hrs	NULP + Zoom
Assessments	LMS Quiz + Rubric	Knowledge check + Concept Note grading	5 hrs	NULP LMS
TOTAL			40 hrs	

5. Module Structure Overview

Module	Title	Key Content	Duration
M1	Climate Finance Landscape & Instruments	GCF, ADB, WB, AIIB; NABARD, NDB; instrument typology: grants, loans, green bonds, carbon credits; project eligibility mapping	6hrs
M2	Municipal Green Bonds — SEBI 2023	SEBI Green Bond Circular 2023; ULB credit rating; use-of-proceeds categories; Green Bond Readiness Checklist; Nashik simulation	8hrs
M3	MDB Instruments for Indian ULBs	ADB Country Partnership Strategy India; World Bank IBRD/IDA; AIIB; KfW; GCF direct access via NABARD; concept note structure	6hrs
M4	Blended Finance Models	Blended finance instruments (guarantees, grants, subordinated debt); Blended Finance Canvas workshop (virtual); Madurai case	6hrs
M5	Carbon Finance for Cities	Urban carbon credit opportunities (SWM, e-buses, forestry, energy); India CCTS for cities; GHG baseline; carbon revenue modelling; Kota W-t-E simulation	8hrs
M6	Concept Note Practicum (Mentored)	NCF Concept Note template; 2 mentor sessions; self-directed drafting; Mentor assessment against 6-criterion rubric	6hrs

6. Assessment and Evaluation Framework

Kirkpatrick Level	Measurement	Instrument	Target
L1 — Reaction	Satisfaction & Relevance	End-of-module surveys (5-point scale) + program completion survey (34 items)	≥ 4.3/5.0
L2 — Learning	Knowledge & Skill	Module quizzes (M1, M3) — 10–12 items each; Concept Note rubric (6 criteria)	Quiz ≥ 70%; CN rubric ≥ 65/100
L3 — Behavior	On-the-Job Transfer	3-month and 6-month follow-up survey; NCF mentor tracking of Concept Note submissions to state/MDB/SEBI	≥ 60% apply at least one framework within 6 months
L4 — Results	Organizational Impact	NCF + GIZ CFC M&E system: formal proposals submitted by participant ULBs within 18 months	≥ 8 ULBs submit formal proposal within 18 months

7. Technology and Risk Register

- Authoring: Articulate Rise 360 (self-paced modules) + Storyline 360 (M5 carbon simulation, 4 decision nodes, 12 outcome pathways)
- LMS: National Urban Learning Platform (NULP) — SCORM 1.2. All modules offline-downloadable for 4G mobile access.
- Virtual Workshops: Zoom (NCF licensed). Recordings available within 48 hours via NULP.
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 Level AA. All videos captioned. Bilingual glossaries (Hindi/Marathi/Tamil) embedded in Rise modules.
- Key Risk: SME availability — mitigated by structured review templates and 2-week buffer in schedule.
- Key Risk: Regulatory content currency (SEBI, CCTS) — modular 'policy slide' architecture allows swap without full rebuild. Annual review scheduled.
- Key Risk: Concept Note quality variability — standardised 6-criterion rubric with inter-rater calibration before pilot.